

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 13 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

01 — NEWS

3 STORIES · MAX 1 POLITICAL

Today's top stories

1

Reform councillor suspended for anti-Islam posts.

Ben Rowe is suspended over a series of Islamophobic and antisemitic posts on social media.

UK · NEWS

2

Students at risk if universities go bust, say MPs.

An Education Select Committee report finds the government needs to make urgent plans for universities facing insolvency.

UK · NEWS

3

Archibald retires from cycling after falling 'in love' with nursing.

Three-time Olympic medallist Katie Archibald retires from cycling - despite being previously chosen for Scotland's 2026 Commonwealth Games team - having "fallen in love" with her new career as a nurse.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

1

Zoe Ball confirms she did not get Strictly presenting role.

The broadcaster says she was "so chuffed to even be in the mix" for the job on the BBC One show.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

Anti-work anthems, Boy George and controversial lyrics: A guide to all 35 Eurovision songs.

From dancefloor bangers to heartfelt ballads, here are the highlights and low points of Eurovision.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

Live from your living room: The rise of concert films and livestreamed gigs.

Can't see your favourite act in the flesh? There might be a solution - but not everyone's a fan.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Ex-Georgia captain Sharikadze gets 11-year ban over urine-swapping scheme.**
Former Georgia captain Merab Sharikadze is banned for 11 years for violating anti-doping rules, with five team-mates handed suspensions of up to six years.
SPORT · UK
- 2 O'Neill turns down Blackburn job to remain with NI.**
Michael O'Neill will not be taking the Blackburn Rovers job on a permanent basis and will remain in his role as Northern Ireland manager.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Mourinho in final negotiations to become Real boss.**
Jose Mourinho is in final negotiations to become Real Madrid's next head coach, 13 years after his first spell at the Bernabeu.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Wales confident Bellamy will stay amid Burnley links.**
Football Association of Wales bosses are "very confident" Craig Bellamy will remain head coach of the national team despite interest from Burnley.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 **The most-Googled DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**
Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.
- 2 **Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.
- 3 **The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 4 **Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 5 **Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 6 **British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.
- 7 **Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 57% of UK workers admit doing THIS while on a work call. What?

ANSWER: GOING TO THE LOO.

Q Asked what makes them feel old, the top answer wasn't grey hairs — it was THIS. What?

ANSWER: NOT RECOGNISING ANY OF THE NAMES AT THE TOP OF THE CHARTS.

TALK TOPIC

- **A study claims our taste in music is 'locked in' by age 14.**

Talk-back: do you still listen to what you loved at 14? And what was on your bedroom wall?

- **What's the most embarrassing thing in your kitchen that you'd hide if guests came round?**

Talk-back: bonus marks for anyone admitting to a Slap Chop or a NutriBullet bought once and never used.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Food.** The UK's bestselling biscuit in 2025 wasn't the Custard Cream or the Hobnob — it was the humble digestive, selling over 70 million packs.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Bristol bakery has started selling 'controversial' jam doughnuts injected with mustard instead of jam, claiming a 'small but loyal' customer base.

06 – LOTTERY

ESTIMATED · THIS WEEK

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.09 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.09 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

8 TO CHOOSE FROM

Did you know?

- The Great Wall of China isn't actually visible from space without aid, despite the myth.
- There are more possible games of chess than atoms in the observable universe.
- A flock of crows is called a 'murder'.
- The unicorn is mentioned in the Bible nine times.
- Coca-Cola would be green if colouring wasn't added to it.
- A day on Venus is longer than a year on Venus.
- Polar bears have black skin under their white fur.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water under certain conditions — it's called the Mpemba effect.

On this day

Day 133 of the year, 232 days left in 2026. Today Abbotsbury Garland Day (Dorset, England); Christian feast day: André-Hubert Fournet; Christian feast day: Our Lady of Fátima; Christian feast day: Conchita Barrecheguren (Roman Catholic). Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2003 — Jabari Smith Jr., American basketball player
- 1998 — Luca Zidane, Algerian footballer
- 1945 — Lou Marini, American saxophonist and composer
- 1993 — Romelu Lukaku, Belgian footballer
- 1944 — Armistead Maupin, American author, screenwriter, and actor
- 1943 — Mary Wells, American singer-songwriter (died 1992)
- 1991 — Junior Messias, Brazilian footballer
- 2003 — Javi Guerra, Spanish footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1998 — India carries out two nuclear weapon tests at Pokhran, following the three conducted on May 11. The United States and Japan impose economic sanctions on India.
- 1995 — Alison Hargreaves, a 33-year-old British mother, becomes the first woman to ascend Everest without oxygen or the help of sherpas.
- 1981 — Mehmet Ali Ağca attempts to assassinate Pope John Paul II in St. Peter's Square in Rome. The Pope is rushed to the Agostino Gemelli University Polyclinic to undergo emergency surgery and survives.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2014 — An explosion at an underground coal mine in southwest Turkey kills 301 miners.
- 1990 — The Dinamo–Red Star riot took place at Maksimir Stadium in Zagreb, Croatia between the Bad Blue Boys (fans of Dinamo Zagreb) and the Delije (fans of Red Star Belgrade).

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1972 — The Troubles: A car bombing outside a crowded pub in Belfast sparks a two-day gun battle involving the Provisional IRA, Ulster Volunteer Force and British Army. Seven people are killed and over 66 injured.

- 2005 — Andijan uprising, Uzbekistan; Troops open fire on crowds of protestors after a prison break; at least 187 people were killed according to official estimates.
- 1995 — Alison Hargreaves, a 33-year-old British mother, becomes the first woman to ascend Everest without oxygen or the help of sherpas.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 134 of the year, 231 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Boniface of Tarsus; Christian feast day: Justa, Justina and Henedina; Christian feast day: Maria Domenica Mazzarello; Christian feast day: Matthias the Apostle (Roman Catholic Church, Anglican Communion, Evangelical Lutheran Church in America). Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1996 — Pokimane, Moroccan-Canadian internet personality
- 1943 — Ólafur Ragnar Grímsson, Icelandic academic and politician, 5th President of Iceland
- 1997 — Rúben Dias, Portuguese footballer
- 1944 — George Lucas, American director, producer, and screenwriter, founded Lucasfilm
- 1994 — Pernille Blume, Danish swimmer
- 1984 — Gary Ablett, Jr., Australian footballer
- 1989 — Rob Gronkowski, American football player
- 1987 — François Steyn, South African rugby player

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1970 — Andreas Baader is freed from custody by Ulrike Meinhof, Gudrun Ensslin and others, a pivotal moment in the formation of the Red Army Faction.
- 2012 — Agni Air Flight CHT crashes in Nepal after a failed go-around, killing 15 people.
- 1935 — The Constitution of the Philippines is ratified by a popular vote.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1940 — World War II: Rotterdam, Netherlands is bombed by the Luftwaffe of Nazi Germany despite a ceasefire, killing about 900 people and destroying the historic city center.
- 1973 — Skylab, the United States' first space station, is launched.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final

JUNE 2026	
THU 4	NBA Finals begin
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)